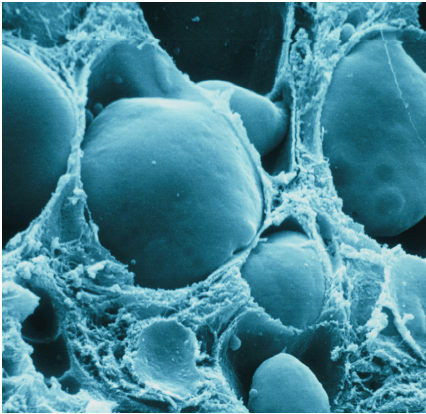




THIS IS **DAY 5 OF YOUR MENSTRUAL CYCLE**
275 days to go

WHAT'S HAPPENING INSIDE

This cross section through the ovary shows several ovarian follicles. Between each follicle, the connective tissue can be seen. Each month about 15–20 follicles mature, but it is usually only one that will fully mature and release an egg.

“ Making some lifestyle changes is essential when you’re trying to get pregnant and cutting down on alcohol is a good start. ”

Try to ensure you’re in the best possible health to maximize fertility. One way is to cut down or stop your alcohol intake and, if you take drugs, seek help to stop.

Heavy drinking can reduce the chances of conceiving and, if you do get pregnant, it can also harm your unborn baby’s development. There is plenty of evidence that drinking beyond the recommended amounts is harmful. What’s lacking is evidence of the effects on conception and pregnancy of the occasional alcoholic drink. There is no known safe level of alcohol consumption for pregnant women. However, many women decide to err on the side of caution and stop drinking alcohol entirely while trying to conceive and in early pregnancy. Some find that morning sickness naturally puts them off alcohol. Alcohol also affects male fertility. It has adverse effects on the quantity and quality of sperm. Drinking large amounts sometimes causes impotence.

You may find alcohol helps you and your partner relax and puts you in the mood for sex, thereby increasing your chances of conception, but you may want to rethink having the very occasional glass of your favorite cocktail.

Illicit or recreational drugs can harm your baby so stop using them before you conceive. Get medical support to stop. Ask your doctor for advice and a referral to a support group.